PROactive PRONUNCIATION

B vs. V Minimal Pairs

The /b/ is produced with both the upper lip and lower lip making contact. The /b/ is voiced as well. The /v/, on the other hand, is different since we must slightly "bite" of the lower lip and elongate the friction. Compare the pronunciation of the words below.

bale	veil
ban	van
bane	vein
bat	vat
beer	veer
bent	vent
berry	very
best	vest
bet	vet
bile	vile
boat	vote
bolt	volt
bow	vow
bowel	vowel
bowl	vole
broom	vroom
bury	very
curb	curve
dribble	drivel
dub	dove
fibre	fiver
gibbon	given
lobes	loaves
rebel	revel
verb	verve